

أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ  
بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

## Lisan ul Quran — Lecture 30

Constructions within the Jumla Ismiyyah · the Murakkab Tawsifi

### 1. The Murakkab Tamm and the kinds of sentence

The word *tamm* means complete. A construction of two or more words from which the sense is completed is called a *Murakkab Tamm*, and a *Murakkab Tamm* is also called a *Jumlah*.

- *Jumla Ismiyyah* — a sentence that begins with an *Ism*.
- *Jumla Fi'liyyah* — a sentence that begins with a *Fi'l*.

### 2. The Jumla Ismiyyah and its rules

A *Jumla Ismiyyah* has two parts. The *Mubtada* is the *Ism* with which the *Jumla Ismiyyah* begins, and the *Khabar* is the *Ism* that tells something about the *Mubtada*.

**A subtle point:** In Arabic the sense of "is" arises from the joining of a *Ma'rifah* with a *Nakirah*. No separate word is brought for it.

| Aspect         | Rule                                                            | How strictly it holds |
|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| Wus'at         | the Mubtada comes as Ma'rifah while the Khabar comes as Nakirah | 99 percent            |
| I'raab         | both the Mubtada and the Khabar come as Marfoo'                 | 100 percent           |
| Jins and 'Adad | there is agreement between the Mubtada and the Khabar           | 99.99 percent         |

**The conclusion:** The *Mubtada* and the *Khabar* are alike in three respects — gender, number and *I'raab*. The only difference is one of *wus'at*: the *Mubtada* is *Ma'rifah* and the *Khabar* is *Nakirah*.

اللَّهُ عَلِيمٌ ، زَيْدٌ قَائِمٌ ، حَدِيجَةٌ مُعَلِّمَةٌ ، فَاطِمَةُ طَبِيبَةٌ

### 3. Constructions within the Jumla Ismiyyah

In all the examples of the *Jumla Ismiyyah* studied so far, the *Mubtada* and the *Khabar* were *mufrad*, single words. But it is not always so. Sometimes the *Mubtada* is a construction, sometimes the *Khabar*, and sometimes both.

| The sentence                                     | Where the construction is         |
|--------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| the tall man is righteous                        | the Mubtada is a Murakkab Tawsifi |
| the Qur'an is the speech of Allah                | the Khabar is a Murakkab Idafi    |
| obedience to the Messenger is obedience to Allah | both are a Murakkab Idafi         |
| these books are new                              | the Mubtada is a Murakkab Isharee |

#### The four possible cases

On this reckoning four cases of the *Jumla Ismiyyah* arise in all.

| # | Mubtada        | Khabar         | Example                             |
|---|----------------|----------------|-------------------------------------|
| 1 | mufrad         | mufrad         | رَيْدٌ قَائِمٌ                      |
| 2 | a construction | mufrad         | أَلْوَلَدُ الطَّوِيلِ صَالِحٌ       |
| 3 | mufrad         | a construction | الشَّرْكُ ضَلَلٌ مُبِينٌ            |
| 4 | a construction | a construction | الصَّبْرُ الْجَمِيلُ قُوْرٌ كَبِيرٌ |

#### The method of analysis

**The steps:** The way to translate such sentences is the same throughout: first settle the Mubtada and the Khabar, then see whether they are *mufrad* or a construction, and if a construction, which kind — and then translate.

1. Separate the Mubtada and the Khabar in the sentence.
2. See whether the Mubtada is mufrad or a construction.
3. See whether the Khabar is mufrad or a construction.
4. If either is a construction, settle its kind — Tawsifi, Idafi, Isharee or Jarri.
5. Now translate.

## 4. A recap of the Murakkab Tawsifi

**Definition:** A *Murakkab Tawsifi* is a construction in which one noun states the quality of another. The first noun is called the *Mawsuf* and the second the *Sifah*.

The *Sifah* is *tabi'* to its *Mawsuf* — that is, in all four aspects of the noun (gender, number, *wus'at* and *I'raab*) the *Sifah* and the *Mawsuf* must be alike.

### For the masculine

| 'Adad     | The sentence                                      | Translation                            |
|-----------|---------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Wahid     | زَيْدٌ وَلَدٌ ذَكِيٌّ                             | Zayd is a clever boy                   |
| Tathniyah | زَيْدٌ وَحَامِدٌ وَلَدَانِ ذَكِيَّانِ             | Zayd and Hamid are two clever boys     |
| Jam'      | زَيْدٌ وَحَامِدٌ وَمَحْمُودٌ أَوْلَادٌ ذَكِيُّونَ | Zayd, Hamid and Mahmud are clever boys |

### For the feminine

| 'Adad     | The sentence                                       | Translation                                 |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Wahid     | زَيْنَبُ بِنْتُ ذَكِيَّةٍ                          | Zaynab is a clever girl                     |
| Tathniyah | زَيْنَبُ وَمَرْيَمُ بِنَتَانِ ذَكِيَّتَانِ         | Zaynab and Maryam are two clever girls      |
| Jam'      | زَيْنَبُ وَمَرْيَمُ وَفَاطِمَةُ بَنَاتٌ ذَكِيَّاتٌ | Zaynab, Maryam and Fatimah are clever girls |

**Observe:** In these sentences the *Mubtada* is an *Ism ul 'Alam* and the *Khabar* is a whole *Murakkab Tawsifi*. As the number of the *Mubtada* changed, both parts of the *Khabar* — the *Mawsuf* and the *Sifah* — changed along with it.

## 5. The Murakkab Tawsifi can be both Mubtada and Khabar

**The reason:** A *Murakkab Tawsifi* can come as both the *Mubtada* and the *Khabar*, because it may be *Nakirah* and may also be *Ma'rifah*.

### 5.1 As the Mubtada

If the *Murakkab Tawsifi* comes at the beginning of a sentence it will be *Ma'rifah* and *Marfoo'*.

|         |                            |
|---------|----------------------------|
| صَالِحٌ | الْوَلَدُ الطَّوِيلُ       |
| Khabar  | Mubtada (Murakkab Tawsifi) |

Translation: The tall boy is righteous.

|         |                            |
|---------|----------------------------|
| مُبِينٌ | الْكِتَابُ الْحَقُّ        |
| Khabar  | Mubtada (Murakkab Tawsifi) |

Translation: The true Book is clear.

## 5.2 As the Khabar

If the *Murakkab Tawsifi* comes in the place of the *Khabar* it will be *Nakirah* and *Marfoo'*.

|                           |           |
|---------------------------|-----------|
| ضَلُّ مُبِينٌ             | الشَّرْكُ |
| Khabar (Murakkab Tawsifi) | Mubtada   |

Translation: Associating partners is manifest error.

|                           |         |
|---------------------------|---------|
| يَوْمٌ مَّشْهُودٌ         | ذَلِكَ  |
| Khabar (Murakkab Tawsifi) | Mubtada |

Translation: That is a day that will be witnessed.

## 5.3 Both a Murakkab Tawsifi

|                           |                            |
|---------------------------|----------------------------|
| فَوْزٌ كَبِيرٌ            | الصَّبْرُ الْجَمِيلُ       |
| Khabar (Murakkab Tawsifi) | Mubtada (Murakkab Tawsifi) |

Translation: Beautiful patience is a great success.

In this sentence there is a *Murakkab Tawsifi* on both sides. The one in the *Mubtada* is *Mu'arraf bil Lam* and the one in the *Khabar* is *Nakirah* — and it is exactly this difference that completes the sentence.

## 6. An important distinction — construction or sentence?

This is the most delicate point of the lesson. One and the same pair of words is sometimes only a *Murakkab Tawsifi* and sometimes a whole sentence. The difference lies solely in *alif lam* and *Tanween*.

| The wording          | What it is                                          | Translation     |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| الْوَلَدُ الطَّوِيلُ | a <i>Murakkab Tawsifi</i> — the sense is incomplete | the tall boy    |
| الْوَلَدُ طَوِيلٌ    | a <i>Jumla Ismiyyah</i> — the sense is complete     | the boy is tall |

**An easy test:** Look at the second word. If it carries *alif lam*, this is a *Murakkab Tawsifi* and the sense is still incomplete. And if it carries *Tanween*, this is a *Jumla Ismiyyah* and the sense is complete.

**The same test was met before:** In Lecture 22 exactly this test was given for the *Murakkab Isharee*: هَذَا الْكِتَابُ is a construction and هَذَا كِتَابٌ is a sentence. The principle is one and the same — a *Ma'rifah* joined to a *Ma'rifah* gives a construction, and a *Ma'rifah* joined to a *Nakirah* gives a sentence.

### How is a *Murakkab Tawsifi* made into a sentence?

Since a *Murakkab Tawsifi* is a *Murakkab Naqis*, to make it a complete sentence a *Nakirah Khabar* must be brought after it. In that case the whole *Murakkab Tawsifi* becomes the *Mubtada*.

- الْوَلَدُ الطَّوِيلُ — the tall boy (the sense is incomplete)
- الْوَلَدُ الطَّوِيلُ صَالِحٌ — the tall boy is righteous (the sense is complete)

## 7. Which construction can stand where

Four *Murakkabat Naqisah* have now been studied. This table sums up where each of them can stand in a *Jumla Ismiyyah*.

| Construction            | Mubtada | Khabar | Explanation                                                                               |
|-------------------------|---------|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <i>Murakkab Tawsifi</i> | yes     | yes    | it may be <i>Ma'rifah</i> and may be <i>Nakirah</i> , so it stands in both places         |
| <i>Murakkab Idafi</i>   | yes     | yes    | Mubtada when the <i>Mudaf Ilayh</i> is <i>Ma'rifah</i> , Khabar when it is <i>Nakirah</i> |
| <i>Murakkab Isharee</i> | yes     | no     | it is always <i>Ma'rifah</i> , while the Khabar is generally <i>Nakirah</i>               |
| <i>Murakkab Jarri</i>   | no      | yes    | it comes as the Khabar, which is called Khabar Shibh Jumlah                               |

The example of the *Murakkab Jarri* was met in Lectures 13 and 14: in الْحَمْدُ، الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ is the *Mubtada* and لِلَّهِ is a *Murakkab Jarri* standing as the *Khabar*.

## 8. A scholarly analysis of the verses of Surah Qaf

قَالَ الْقُرْآنِ الْمَجِيدِ ﴿١﴾ بَلْ عَجِبُوا أَنْ جَاءَهُمْ مُنْذِرٌ مِنْهُمْ فَقَالَ الْكَافِرُونَ هَذَا شَيْءٌ عَجِيبٌ ﴿٢﴾ إِذَا مِتْنَا وَكُنَّا تُرَابًا—ذَلِكَ رَجْعٌ بَعِيدٌ ﴿٣﴾

(Surah Qaf: 1 to 3)

**Translation:** Qaf. By the glorious Qur'an. But they wonder that a warner has come to them from among themselves, so the disbelievers say: this is an astonishing thing. When we have died and become dust? That is a far return.

### 8.1 Hadha shay'un 'ajeeb

| Element    | Details                                                                        |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| هَذَا      | an Ism ul Isharah, Ma'rifah and Mabni. Here it is the Muftada of the sentence  |
| شَيْءٌ     | the Mawsuf — Nakirah, Marfoo', singular, masculine                             |
| عَجِيبٌ    | the Sifah — Nakirah, Marfoo', singular, masculine                              |
| Conclusion | هَذَا شَيْءٌ عَجِيبٌ, being a Murakkab Tawsifi, stands as the Khabar for هَذَا |

**Translation:** This is an astonishing thing.

### 8.2 Dhalika raj'un ba'eed

| Element    | Details                                                                                     |
|------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ذَلِكَ     | an Ism ul Isharah, Ma'rifah and Mabni. This is the Muftada of the sentence                  |
| رَجْعٌ     | the Mawsuf — Nakirah, Marfoo', singular, masculine                                          |
| بَعِيدٌ    | the Sifah — equal to its Mawsuf in all four aspects                                         |
| Conclusion | this Murakkab Tawsifi stands as the Khabar for the Muftada and completes the Jumla Ismiyyah |

## 9. A rhetorical point — Dhalika as a pointing of honour

In the rhetoric and style of Arabic the word ذَلِكْ is sometimes used even for something near at hand. There are two reasons for this.

| Reason               | Details                                                                                                                        |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Honour and elevation | it is to tell the one addressed that the thing being spoken of stands very high in rank and greatness, as in ذَلِكِ الْكِتَابُ |

| Reason                | Details                                                                                                     |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| The kinds of distance | distance is not only bodily; sometimes a far pointing is brought to convey elevation of meaning and of rank |

This is why ذٰلِكَ رَجَعُ بُعِيدٌ is rendered "that is a far return", where ذٰلِكَ conveys elevation of rank.

**This was met before:** In Lecture 17 this very point was studied in detail under the names *Bu'd Makani* and *Bu'd Rutbi*, where the example of ذٰلِكَ الْكِتَابُ was given.

## Summary

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1. Tamm means complete. A construction from which the sense is completed is called a Murakkab Tamm, and it is also called a Jumlah.
2. A sentence is of two kinds: the Jumla Ismiyyah, which begins with an Ism, and the Jumla Fi'liyyah, which begins with a Fi'l.
3. A Jumla Ismiyyah has two parts: the Muftada and the Khabar.
4. In Arabic the sense of "is" arises from the joining of a Ma'rifah with a Nakirah; no separate word is brought for it.
5. In respect of wus'at the Muftada is Ma'rifah and the Khabar Nakirah, and this holds in 99 percent of cases.
6. In respect of l'raab both come as Marfoo', and this holds in 100 percent of cases.
7. There is agreement in gender and number, and this holds in 99.99 percent of cases.
8. So the Muftada and the Khabar are alike in three respects and differ only in wus'at.
9. In a Jumla Ismiyyah the Muftada is sometimes a construction, sometimes the Khabar, and sometimes both.
10. On this reckoning four cases arise: both muftad, the Muftada a construction, the Khabar a construction, or both.
11. The method is to settle the Muftada and the Khabar first, then see whether they are muftad or a construction, and which kind.
12. A Murakkab Tawsifi is one in which a noun states the quality of another; the first is the Mawsuf and the second the Sifah.
13. The Sifah follows its Mawsuf in all four aspects.
14. A Murakkab Tawsifi can be both Muftada and Khabar, because it may be Ma'rifah and may be Nakirah.
15. As the Muftada it is Ma'rifah and Marfoo', as in **الْوَلَدُ الطَّوِيلُ صَالِحٌ**.
16. As the Khabar it is Nakirah and Marfoo', as in **السَّرْكُ ضَلُّ مُبِينٌ**.
17. In **الْصَّبْرُ الْجَمِيلُ قَوْرٌ كَبِيرٌ** there is a Murakkab Tawsifi on both sides.
18. **الْوَلَدُ الطَّوِيلُ** is a Murakkab Tawsifi and the sense is incomplete, while **الْوَلَدُ طَوِيلٌ** is a sentence and the sense is complete.
19. The test is that alif lam on the second word gives a construction, and Tanween gives a sentence.
20. The Murakkab Tawsifi and the Murakkab Idafi may stand in both places, the Murakkab Isharee only as Muftada, and the Murakkab Jarri only as Khabar.
21. In Surah Qaf, **هَذَا شَيْءٌ عَجِيبٌ** and **ذَلِكَ رَجْعٌ بَعِيدٌ** both have an Ism ul Isharah as Muftada and a Murakkab Tawsifi as Khabar.
22. **ذَلِكَ** sometimes comes even for what is near, on account of honour and elevation or of elevation in meaning.

## Exercise

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1. Define the Murakkab Tamm and describe both kinds of sentence.
2. Define both parts of a Jumla Ismiyyah.
3. How does the sense of "is" arise in Arabic?
4. Write all three rules of the Muftada and the Khabar with how strictly each holds.
5. In which respects are the Muftada and the Khabar alike, and in which do they differ?
6. Write all four possible cases of the Jumla Ismiyyah with examples.
7. Write out all five steps for analysing a Jumla Ismiyyah.
8. Define the Murakkab Tawsifi and name both of its elements.
9. Form the six sentences, masculine and feminine, with the word Dhakiyy.
10. Why can a Murakkab Tawsifi be both Muftada and Khabar?
11. What will the wus'at of a Murakkab Tawsifi be when it comes as Muftada and when as Khabar?
12. Give a full analysis of الصَّبْرُ الْجَمِيلُ قَوْرٌ كَبِيرٌ.
13. What is the difference between أَلْوَدُ الطَّوِيلُ and أَلْوَدُ طَوِيلٌ? Write the test as well.
14. How is a Murakkab Tawsifi made into a complete sentence?
15. Which of the four constructions can stand where? Set it out in a table.
16. Analyse هَذَا شَيْءٌ عَجِيبٌ element by element.
17. Separate the Muftada and the Khabar in ذَلِكَ رَجْعٌ بَعِيدٌ and state the standing of each.
18. Give both reasons for the pointing of honour with ذَلِكَ.

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سُبْحَانَكَ اللَّهُمَّ وَبِحَمْدِكَ، أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ، أَسْتَغْفِرُكَ وَأَتُوبُ إِلَيْكَ

اللَّهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا صَلَّيْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ

اللَّهُمَّ بَارِكْ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا بَارَكْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ